

Online Safety & Acceptable Use Policy

Keeping young people safe online and around devices

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE · Alternative Provision for Ages 5–25

ADOPTED POLICY

This policy has been formally adopted by L-Fit Pathways' co-directors and is in effect from the date shown below. Any section still shown in [square brackets and amber text] is organisation-specific detail that remains to be confirmed and inserted - it does not affect the rest of the policy's validity but should be completed as soon as possible.

Version: 1.0 (Adopted)

Date Adopted: 16 September 2026

Next Review Due: 16 September 2027 (or sooner following any legislative change or relevant incident)

1. Statement of Intent

L-Fit Pathways is committed to ensuring young people, staff and volunteers use technology and the internet safely and responsibly across all of our provision, including our Digital Detox sessions, tuition, and general use of devices during the day.

2. Legal & Statutory Framework

- Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026 — including statutory guidance on online safety
- The Prevent Duty (Counter-Terrorism and Security Act 2015)
- UK GDPR & Data Protection Act 2018

3. Young People's Use of Devices

- Personal devices used by young people during sessions (other than Digital Detox) are used only for agreed educational purposes, with staff supervision
- During Digital Detox sessions, personal devices are stored securely for the duration of the session and returned promptly at the end, with a calm, supported handover and return process
- Any internet access provided as part of tuition is supervised, with age-appropriate content

4. Staff Conduct

- Staff do not contact young people via personal social media accounts or personal phone numbers
- Staff do not photograph young people on personal devices — see our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy for our photography and consent procedure
- All professional communication with young people and families is conducted through official L-Fit Pathways contact channels

5. Responding to Online Safety Concerns

Any concern about a young person's online safety, including cyberbullying, grooming, exposure to harmful content, or radicalisation, is reported to a Designated Safeguarding Lead immediately and handled under our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy.

6. Reporting a Concern

Young people and families are encouraged to report anything that worries them online to a member of staff or directly to a DSL: Adam Byrne or Craig Lloyd.

7. Roles & Responsibilities

Both DSLs hold responsibility for online safety across L-Fit Pathways and receive training on current online risks as part of their Level 5 Safeguarding/DSL training.

8. Monitoring & Review

This policy is reviewed annually, or sooner following an online safety incident or significant change in guidance.

Policy adopted on: 16 September 2026 — Next review due: 16 September 2027